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Security Priorities Study



Purpose and methodology

Survey goal

To gain a better understanding of the various security projects organizations are focused on now and in the coming year. The research also looks at issues that will demand the most time and strategic thinking for IT and security teams.

Total respondents: 641

Collection method: Online questionnaire

Number of questions: 30

Region

North America: 46%

EMEA: 18%

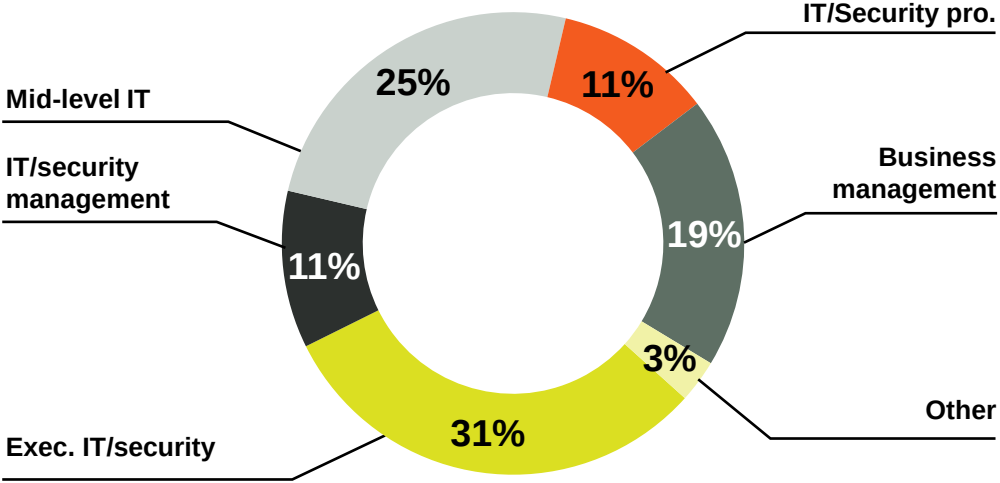
APAC: 36%

Average company size: 14,494 employees

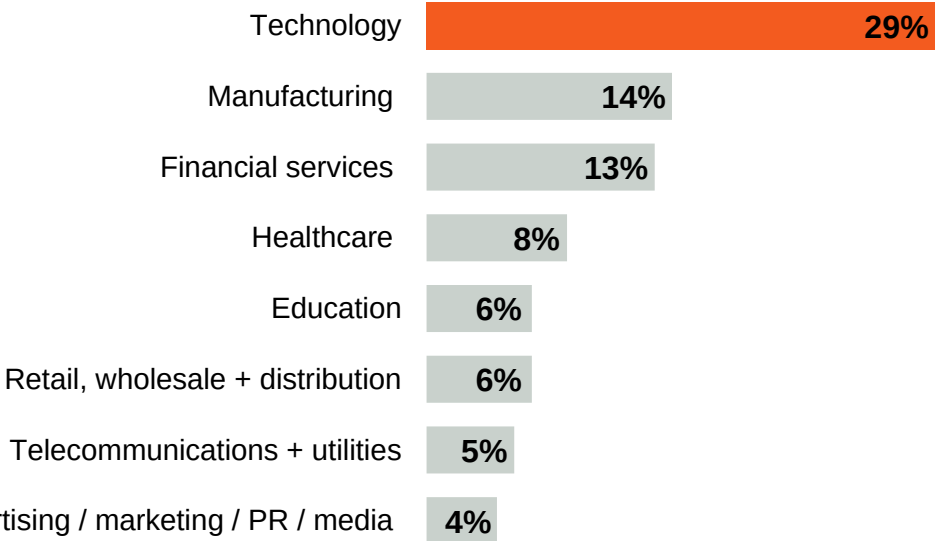
IT Leadership: All survey respondents are involved in IT and/or corporate/physical security decisions.

Audience base: CIO, Computerworld, CSO, InfoWorld and Network World site visitors, and email invitations to audience base

Job titles



Top represented industries



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The security situation



What's happening in the security department?

76%

of security decision-makers
say that understanding
which security tools and solutions
fit best within their company
is **becoming more complex.**

57%

say their organization has
**struggled to find the root cause
of security incidents**
they've experienced
over the past 12 months.

Question: Please rate your level of agreement with the following statements

The role of the security decision-maker is expanding

67%

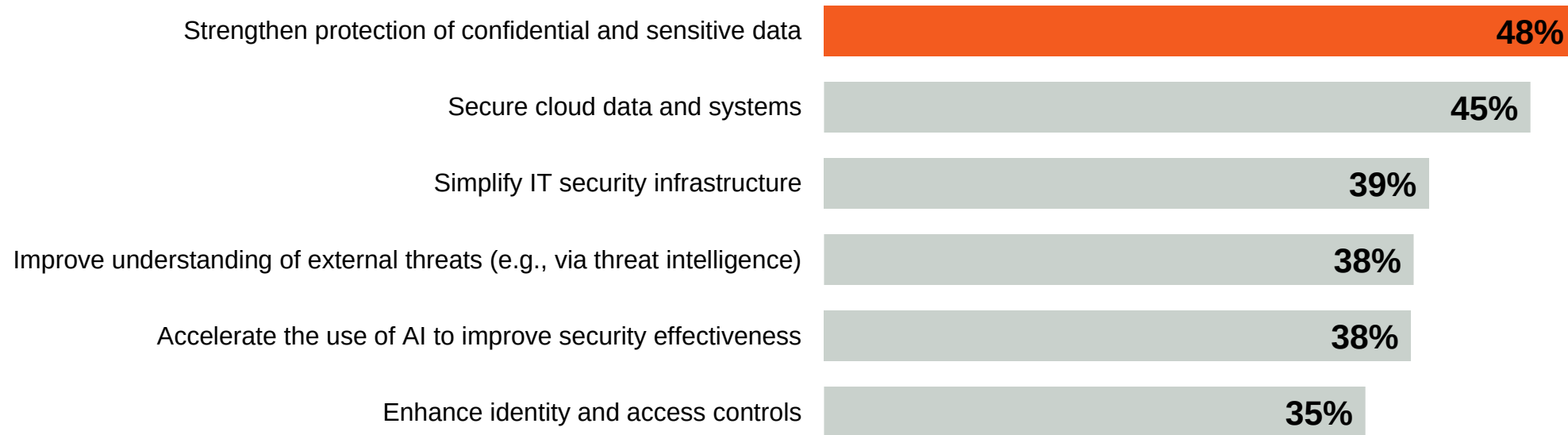
agree that their **responsibilities** include addressing information security issues **outside of their country or region**.

Top five responsibilities they are taking on:

1. **Cybersecurity strategy and policy development**
2. **Risk management**
3. **Security architecture and technology updates**
4. **Managing the risks of AI-enabled technology**
5. **Innovation and emerging technologies**

Question: Has your role expanded to include additional responsibilities over the past 12 months? AND What additional responsibilities have you taken on in your role?

Key security priorities organizations are focused on



Question: What are your organizations top security priorities for the coming year?

Top five challenges inhibiting security goal achievement

1

Employee awareness training

2

Lack of sufficient budget

3

Addressing the risks presented by disruptive technologies (AI, machine learning, IoT)

4

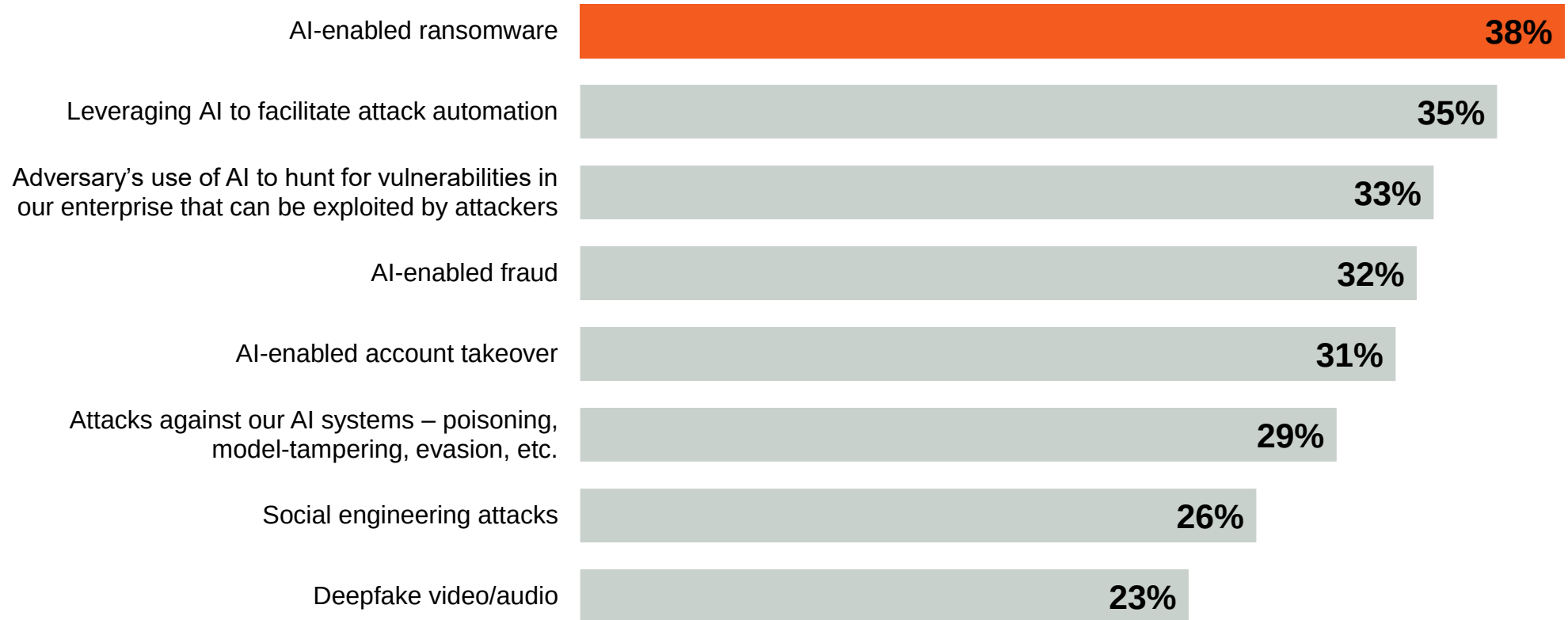
Retaining qualified security employees

5

Process complexity

Question: What challenges are keeping you from achieving your security goals?

AI-enabled attacks are a concern to security buyers



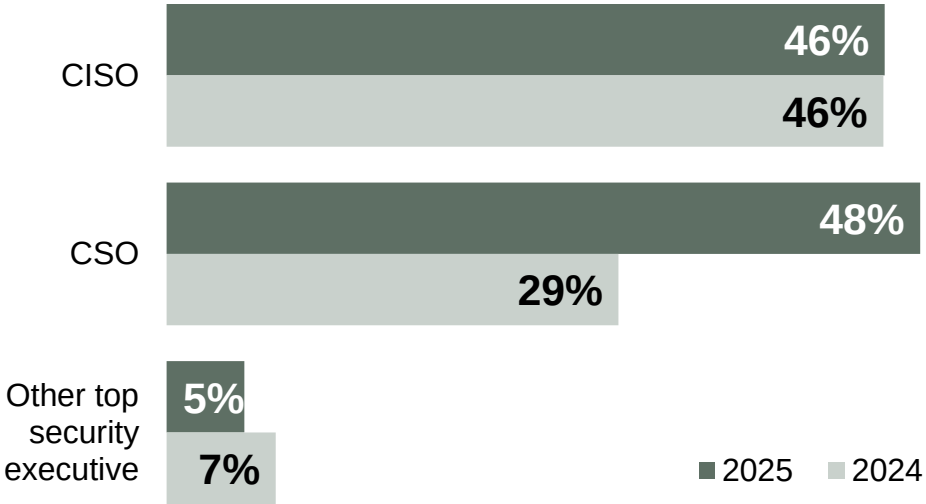
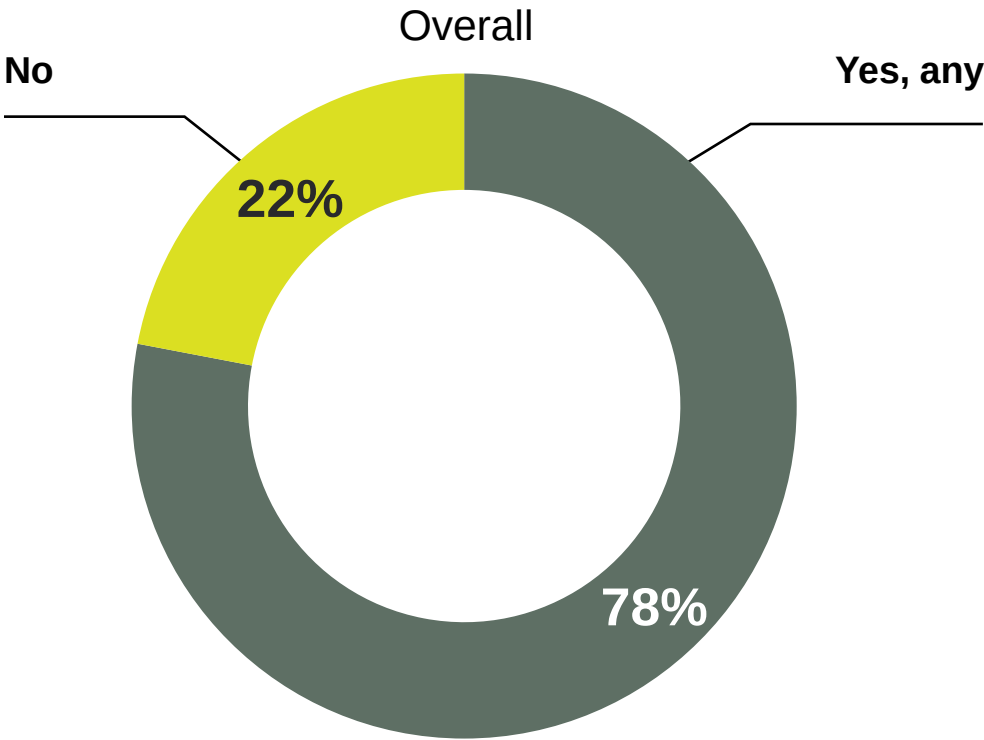
Question: AI is being used to enable attacks against many organizations. Of the following AI-enabled attacks, which concern you the most?

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Security's role within the organization

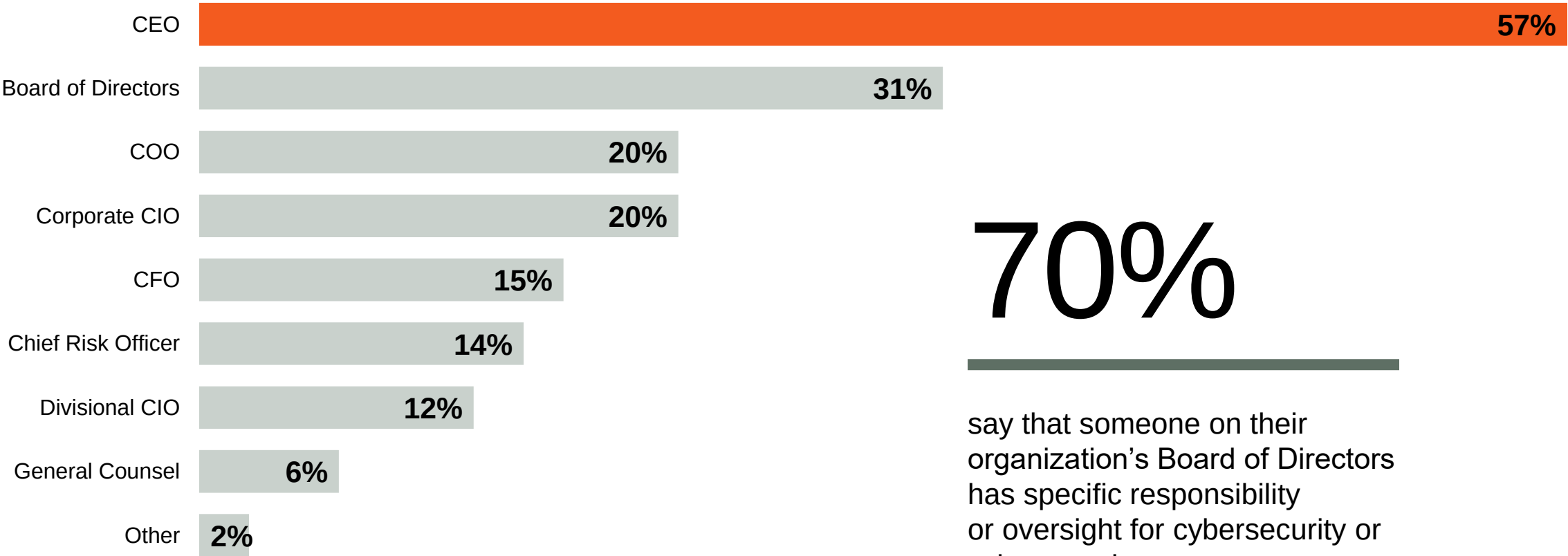


Companies continue to invest in CSOs



Question: Does your company have a CISO, CSO or top security executive? (Please select all that apply)

Reporting structure of security executives



70%

say that someone on their organization’s Board of Directors has specific responsibility or oversight for cybersecurity or cybersecurity management.

Question: To whom does your CISO, CSO or equivalent report, directly and indirectly?

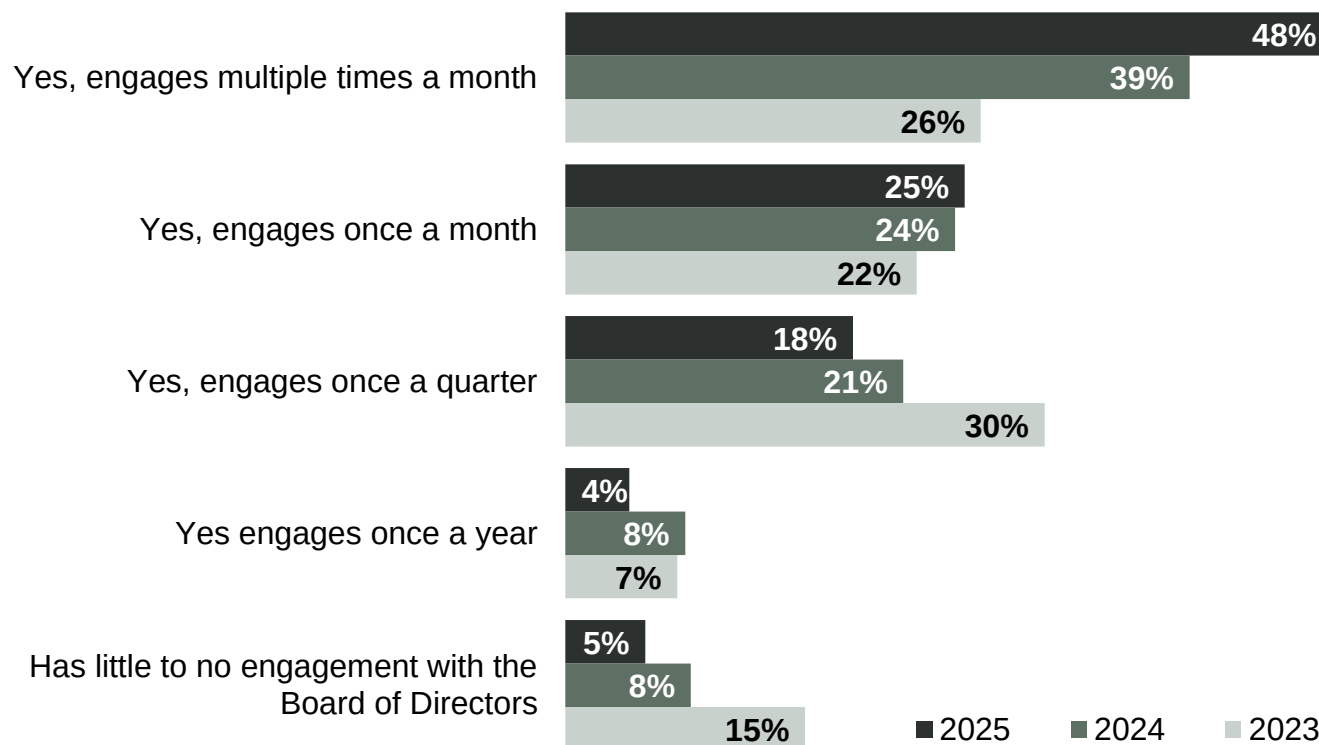
Up from 59% in 2024.

Top security execs engage with Board multiple times a month

95%

of top IT security executives have engagement with their Board of Directors.

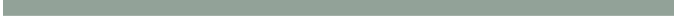
Up from 85% in 2023.



Question: Does your CSO/CISO/top security executive have regular engagement with the Board of Directors?

Security prioritization apparent with specific roles + oversight

64%



of organizations **have one or more BISOs** (Business Information Security Officers) reporting to the CSO, CISO or top security executive.

70%



say that someone on their organization's **Board of Directors has specific responsibility or oversight** for cybersecurity or cybersecurity management.

72%



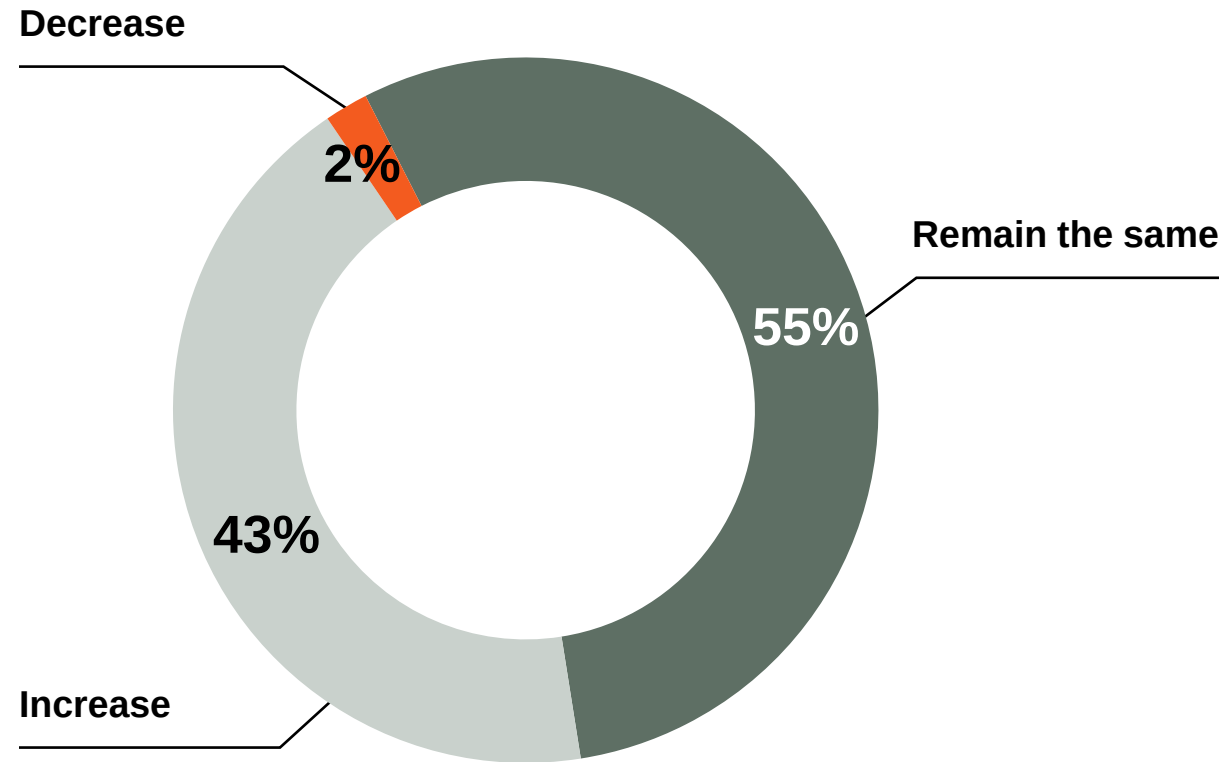
agree that their engagement with the Board of Directors helps improve cybersecurity / security initiatives.
Up from 66% in 2024.

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Security investment plans

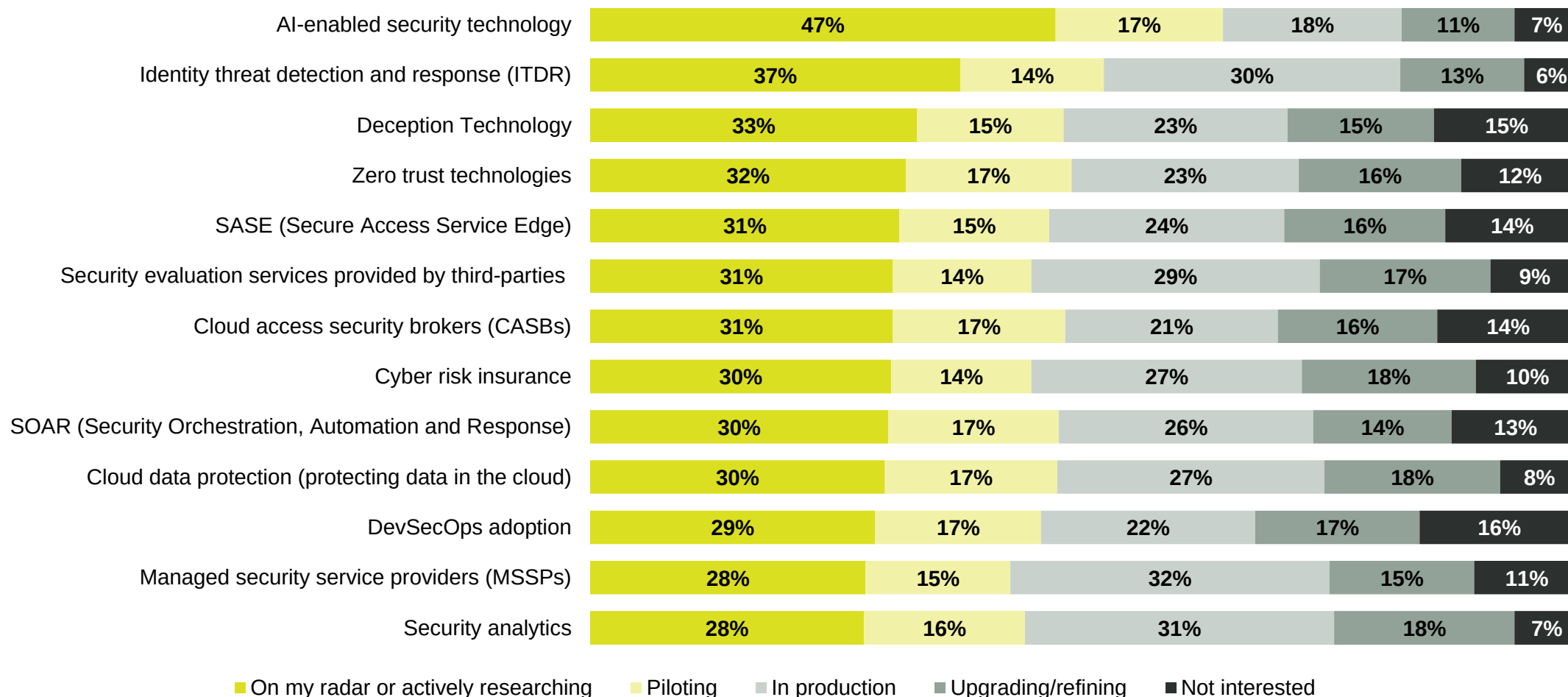


Security budgets expected to increase or hold steady



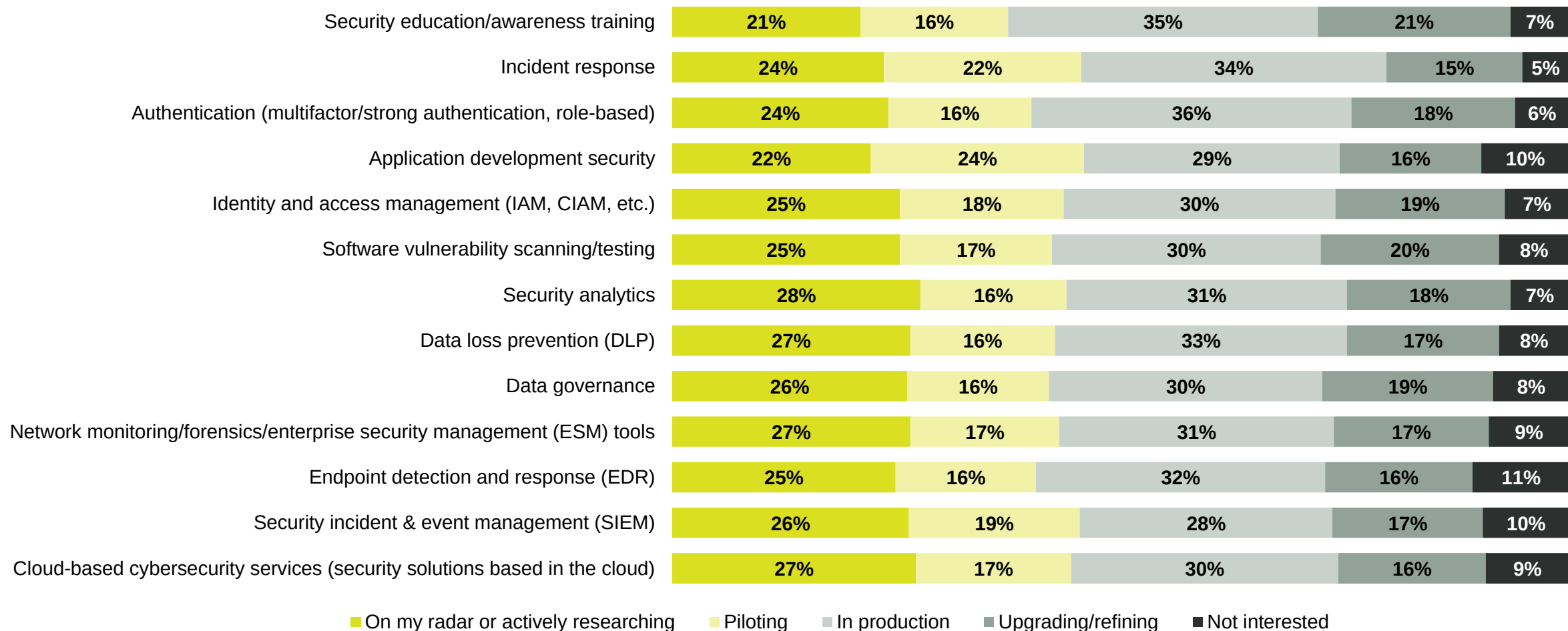
Question: Do you expect your organization's overall security budget to increase, decrease or remain the same in the next 12 months?

Security solutions on the radar



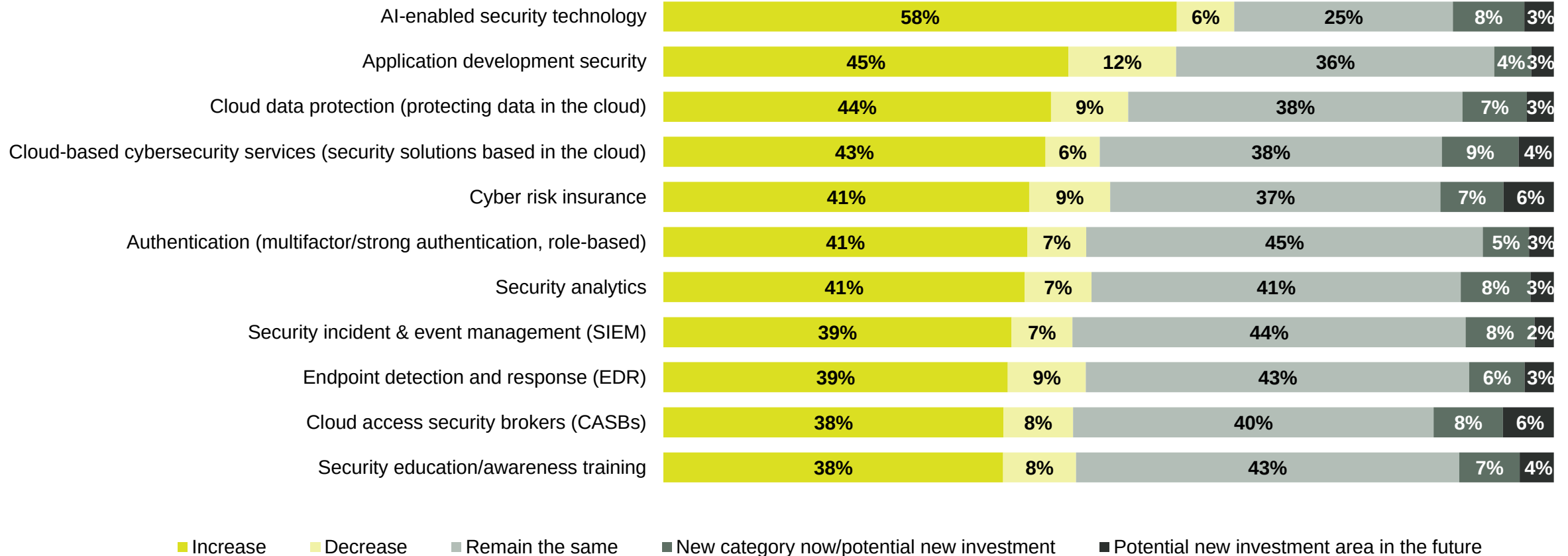
Question: Which option best describes your current activity for each of the following security solutions, services, or models?

Security solutions currently in use



Question: Which option best describes your current activity for each of the following security solutions, services, or models?

AI-enabled security tools see the greatest increase in spending



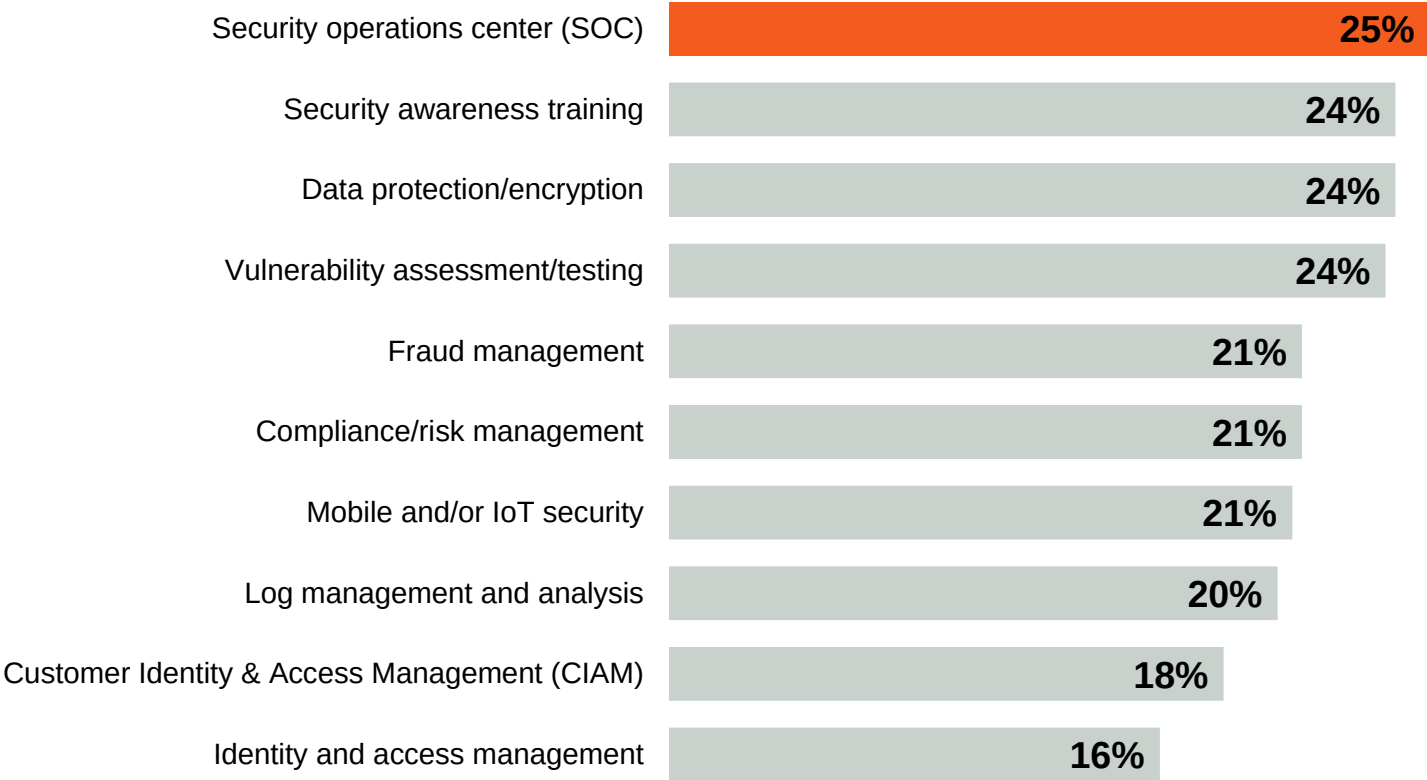
Question: Please describe how your company's level of spending in the following areas will change over the next 12 months.

Planning to outsource these security functions

90%

will outsource security functions to a managed security services provider or other third-party in the next 12 months.

Up from 82% in 2024.



Question: Which of the following security functions will your organization outsource over the next 12 months to a managed security services provider or other third-party (not including SaaS)?

Business priorities driving security spending



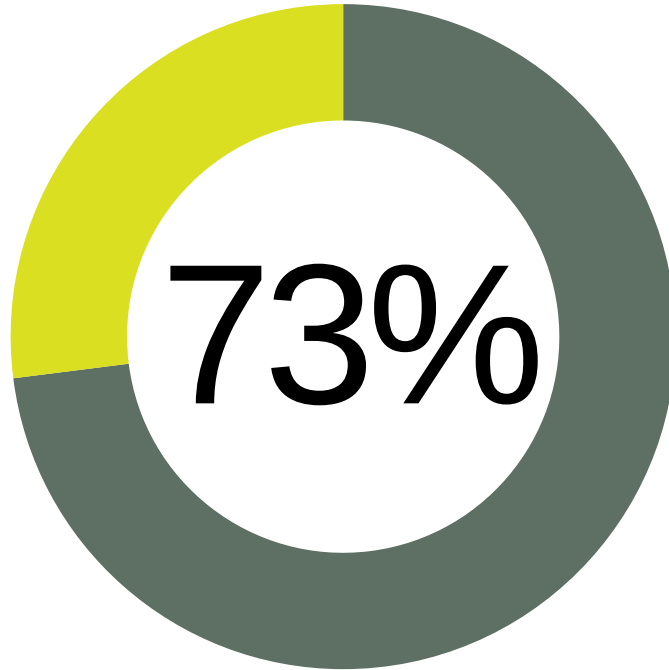
Question: Which of the following business priorities are driving security spending at your organization over the next 12 months?

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Activity around AI-enabled security solutions



Security buyers more likely to consider AI security tools

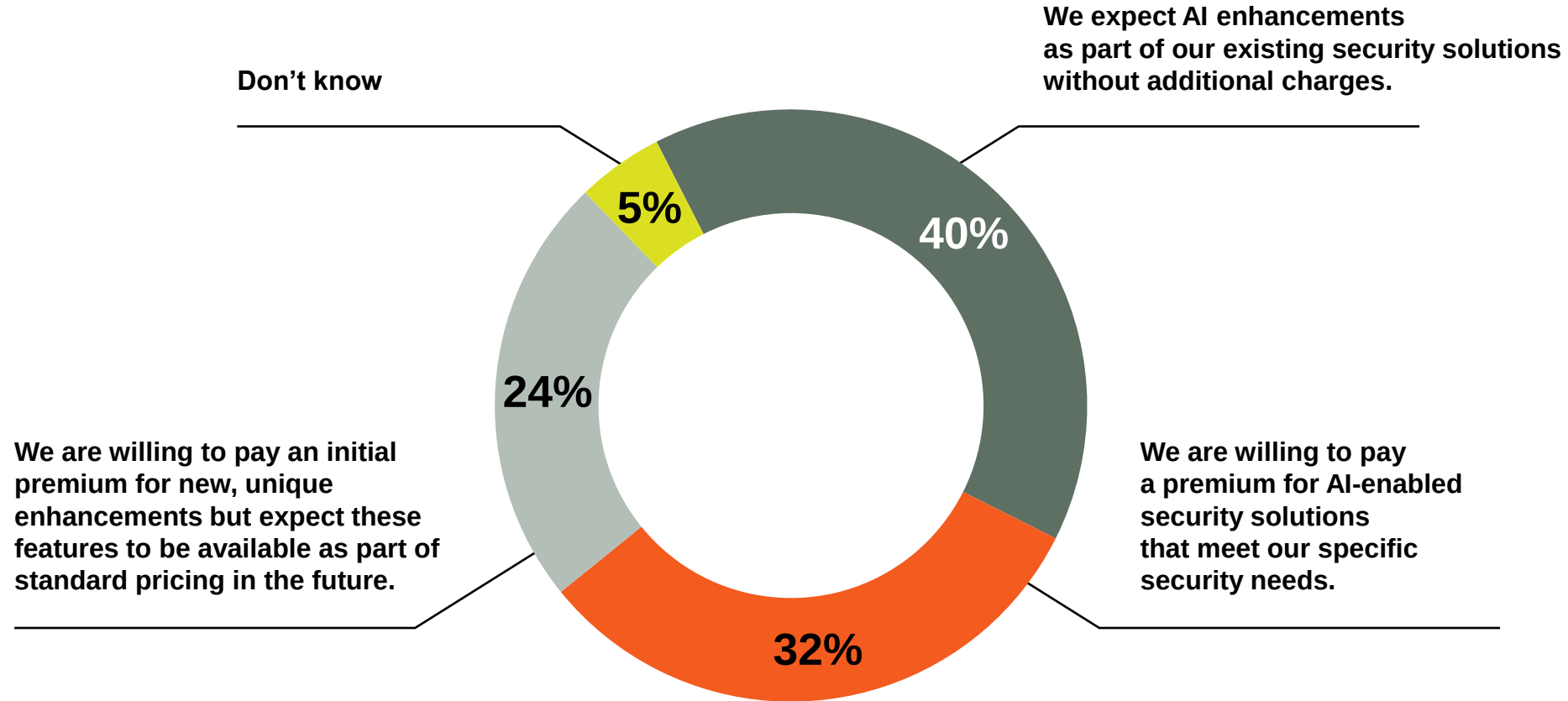


of security decision-makers say that their organization is more likely to consider a security solution that uses Artificial Intelligence (AI).

Up from 59% in 2024.

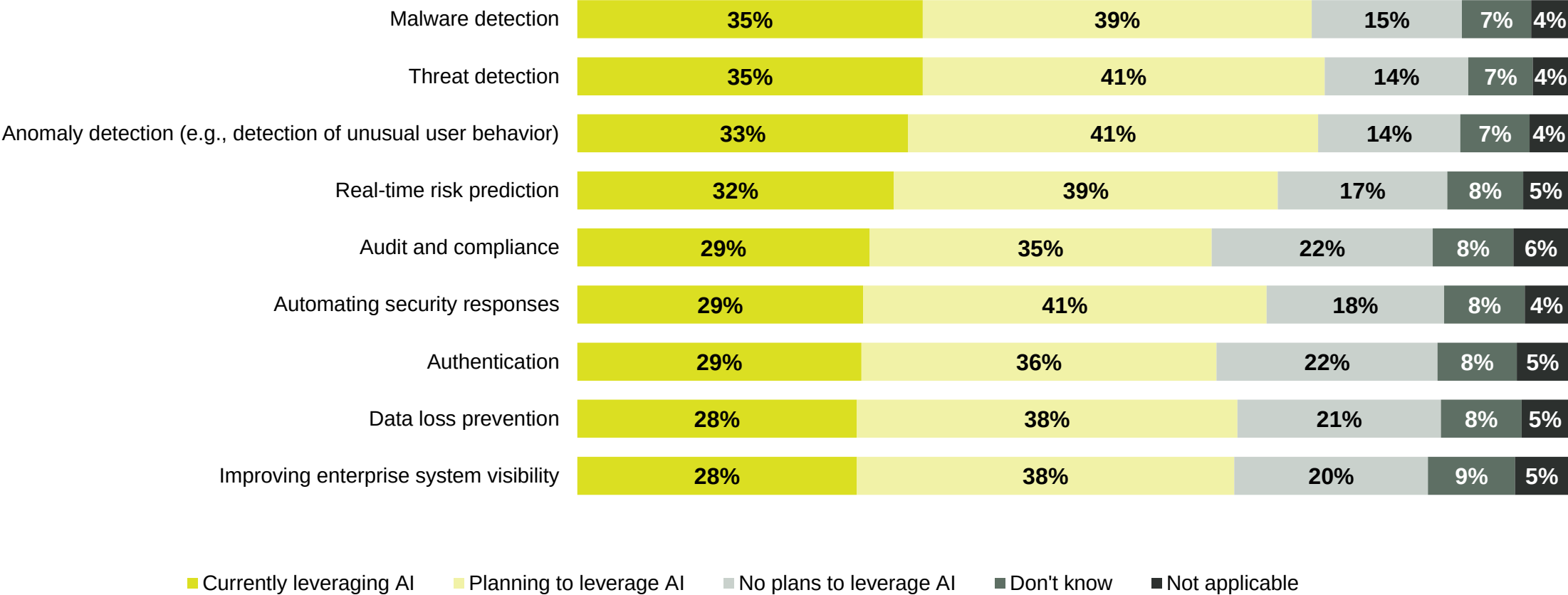
Question: Please rate your level of agreement with the following statements:

And they're expecting their vendors to add AI enhancements



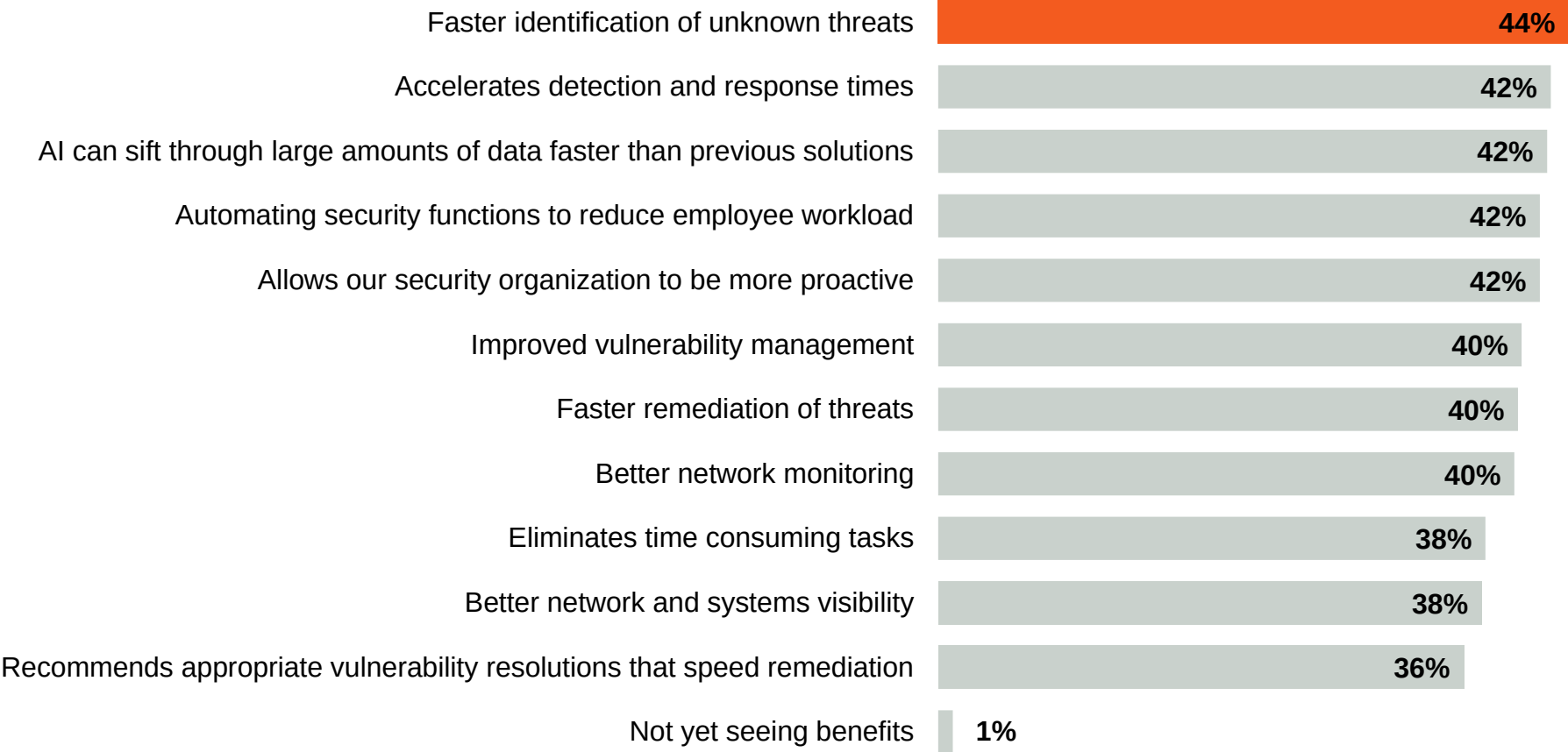
Question: What is your organization's stance on investing in AI-enabled security solutions?

Many plans to leverage AI in security technologies



Question: In which areas are you leveraging or planning to leverage Artificial Intelligence (AI) in your security technologies?

Benefits from AI-enabled security tech



99%

have seen benefits from the AI-enabled security technologies utilized by their organization.

Up from 72% in 2023.

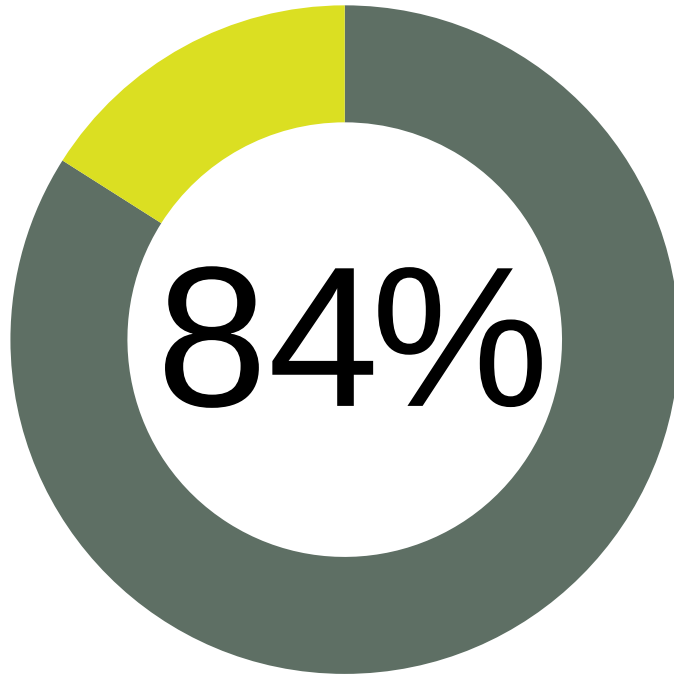
Question: What benefits are you currently seeing from AI-enabled security technologies utilized by your organization?

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Demographics



Top IT + security executives

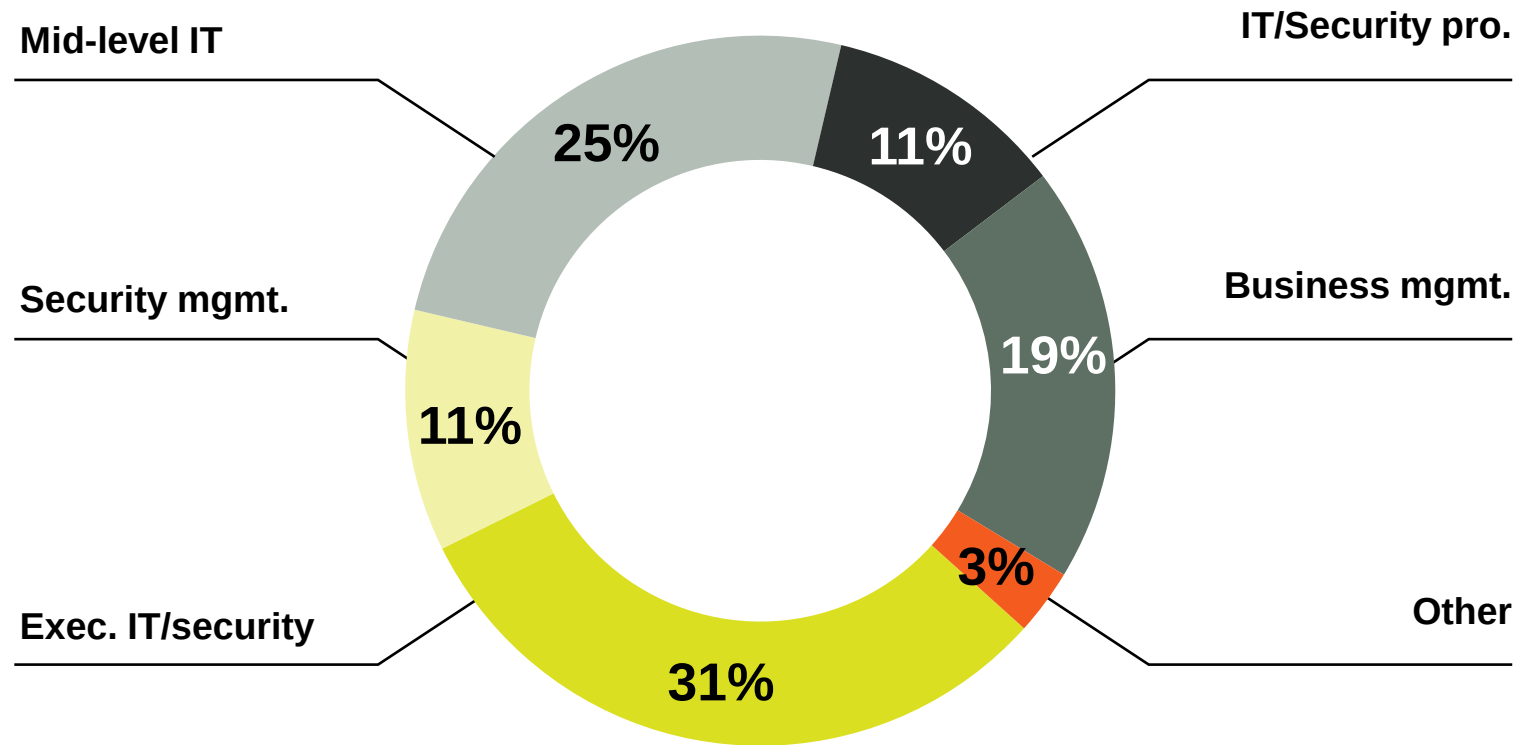


of security decision-makers say that they are the top IT or security executive in their company or business unit / location.

Top IT executive: 62%
Top security executive: 22%

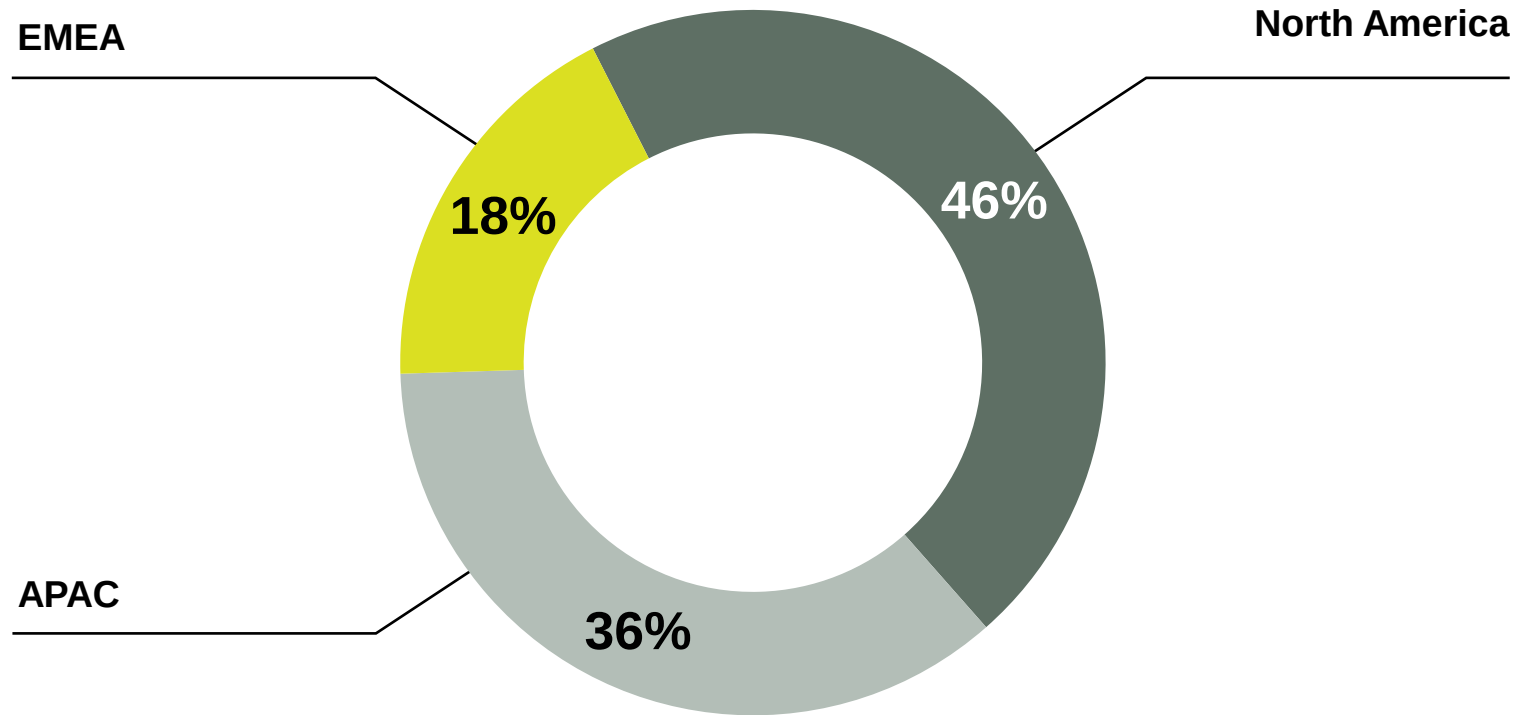
Question: Are you the top IT or security executive in your company or business unit/location?

Job titles



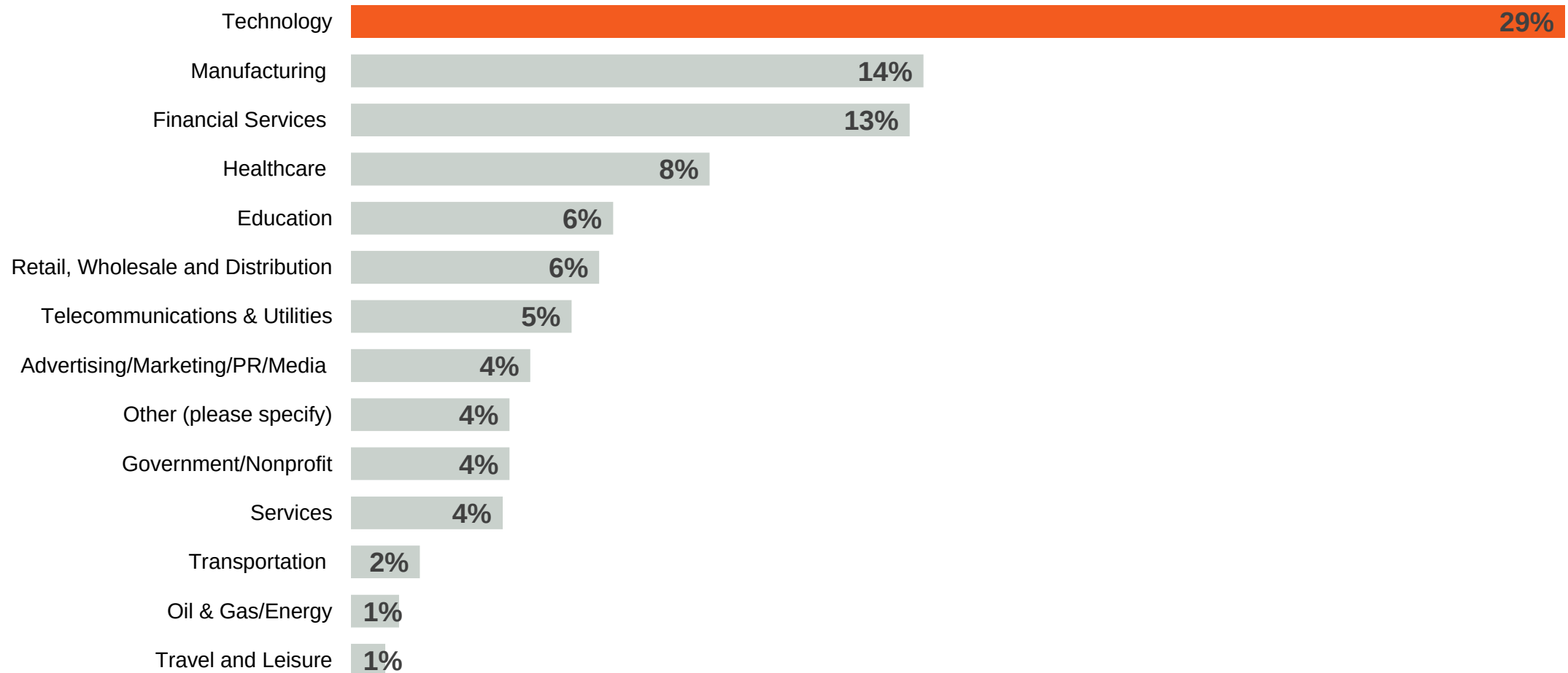
Question: What is your primary job title?

Regions



Question: In which country or region do you currently reside?

Organization industry / function

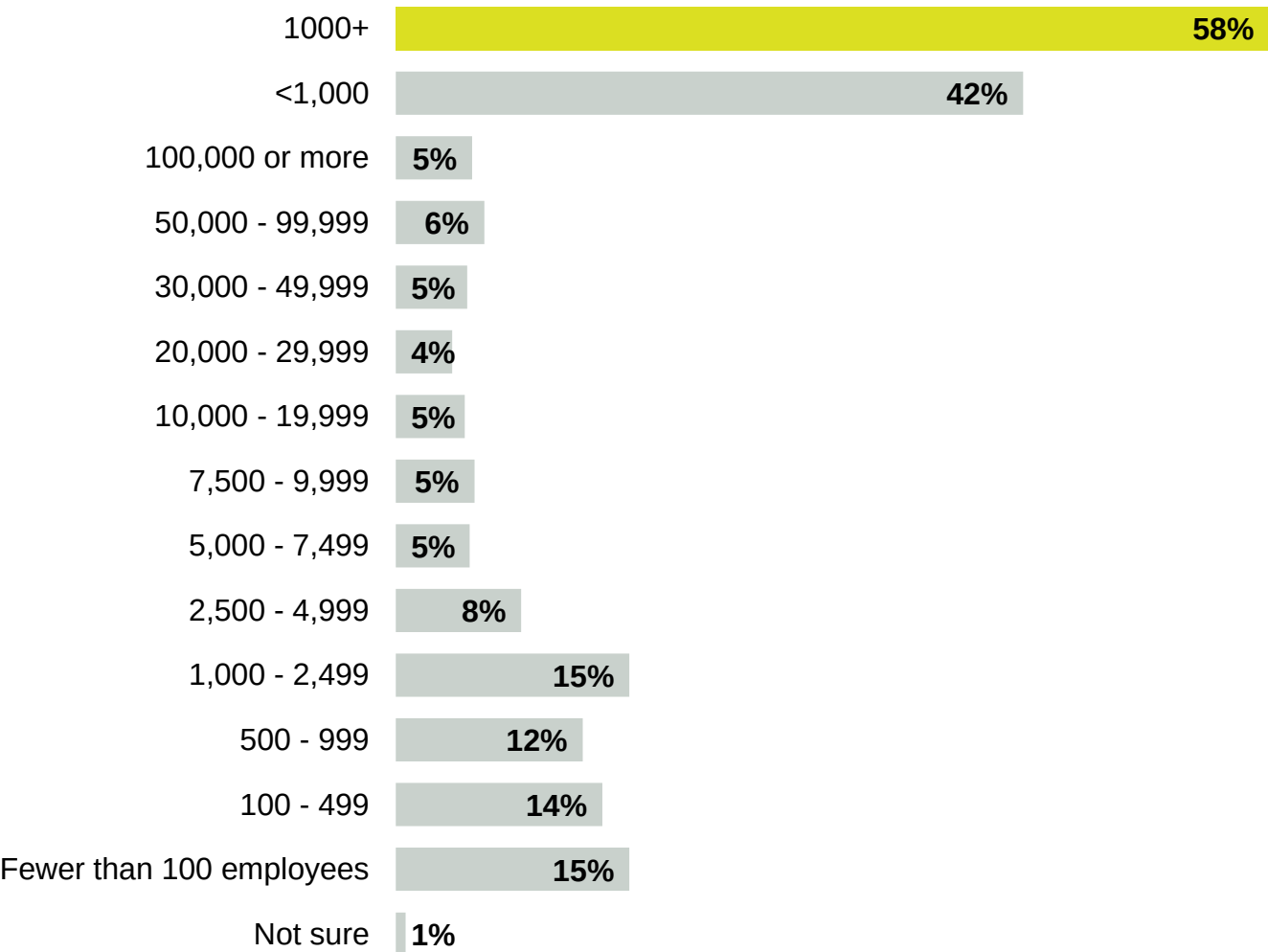


Question: Which of the following best describes your organization's industry or function?

Company size

14,494
employees

Average company size



Question: Approximately how many people are employed in your entire organization or enterprise? (Please include all plants, divisions, branches, parents and subsidiaries worldwide.)

Thank you

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